5.1 Introduction

Successful treatment of the sick depends on correct diagnosis and correct diagnosis depends on a great deal of an accurate observations. It is therefore most important that the Health Worker develops skill in making accurate observations on patients. She must also be able to record her observations correctly, clearly and neatly.

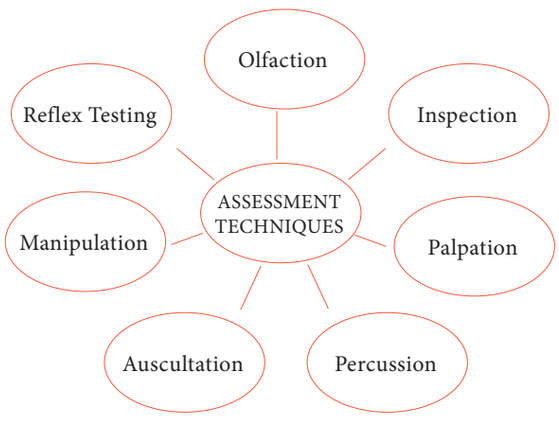
5.2 Definition

Health assessment is an important component in health care for proper diagnosis and effective treatment. Health assessment includes the following

1. Anthropometric measurement includes height, weight, and circumference of head, chest, mid-arm.
   - Systemwise examination
   - Recording height and weight

1. Mental status examination
2. Laboratory investigation
3. Special investigation

5.3 Assessment Techniques



1. Inspection: It means looking with eyes it reveals any rush scar, colour, size, shape, contour and symmetry of the body parts.
2. Palpation: It means feeling using sense of touch. It reveals any swelling, coldness, hotness, stiffness, hardness, smoothness roughness, pain, vibration, firmness and flaccidity



3. Percussion: It means striking or tapping with fingers. It elicits sounds which indicate whether the underlined tissue is solid or filled with fluid.



The sounds may vary

a) Resonant: A loud sound over the normal lung tissue
b) Tympanic: A drum like sound over the air filled tissues such as gastric air bubble
c) Dull: A medium pitched sound with medium duration without resonance, heard over the solid tissues, such as heart, liver.
d) Flat: A pitched sound with short duration without resonance, heard over the complete solid tissues, such as bones.

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